

Ἀριστόνικος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς

Aristonicus of Alexandria on Signs in Homer

eul_aid: mia

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Γραμματική [Grammar](#)
Format: Συναγωγή [Collection](#)

Aristonicus of Alexandria was a Greek grammarian and scholar active during the late Hellenistic and early Roman Imperial periods, approximately from the 1st century BCE to the 1st century CE. He belonged to the tradition of Alexandrian scholarship dedicated to editing and explicating classical Greek texts. Aristonicus was active in Rome and a contemporary of figures such as the geographer Strabo.

His most significant work was a collection titled **On the Signs of the Iliad and Odyssey**. This book elucidated the system of critical marks—including obeloi and asterisks—that earlier Alexandrian editors like Aristarchus had placed in the margins of Homer’s epic poems. Aristonicus’s own treatise does not survive intact but is preserved in fragments within the ancient commentaries found in medieval manuscripts of Homer. He may have authored other grammatical works, but these are lost and their precise titles remain uncertain.

Aristonicus’s historical importance lies in his role as a preserver of earlier scholarly traditions. His explanations of the critical signs provide a vital link to the methods of Hellenistic textual criticism. Although his writings survive only fragmentarily, they are frequently cited in the margins of Homeric manuscripts, making his work an essential source for understanding how ancient scholars studied and edited Homeric poetry.

Works (4)

- Περὶ τῶν σημείων τῆς Ἰλιάδος · [On Signs in the Iliad](#) · 11703 passages
- Περὶ Σημίων Ὀδυσσεΐας · [On Signs in the Odyssey](#) · 4645 passages
- Ἀπόσπασμα · [On the Origins of Tragic Dance](#) · 1 passages
- Μαρτυρίαι · [Testimonies](#) · 5 passages